

HEEJUN KIM

 [Homepage](#)  [Email](#)  [GitHub](#)  [Google Scholar](#)

EDUCATION

Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST)

September 2026 - present

M.S. in Artificial Intelligence, supervised by [Prof. Sehoon Kim](#)

Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology (GIST)

February 2020 - August 2026

B.S. in Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, GPA: 4.2/4.5 (magna cum laude)

University of California, Berkeley (UC Berkeley)

June 2024 - August 2024

Summer Session, GPA 4.0/4.0

RESEARCH EXPERIMENTS

Scalable and Efficient AI Lab

September 2026 - present

Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology, Advisor: [Prof. Sehoon Kim](#)

Seoul, South Korea

- Improving reasoning capabilities and accelerating inference in recursive architectures

Learning and Adaptation Algorithm Lab

January 2026 - August 2026

Seoul National University, Advisor: [Prof. Taesup Kim](#)

Seoul, South Korea

- Conducting research on Agentic Memory Using LLM Uncertainty Estimation
- Studied internal behavioral mechanisms of LLMs underlying reasoning, hallucination, and memory recall

Data Science Lab

Feb 2025 - August 2026, January 2024 - June 2024

Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology, Advisor: [Prof. Sundong Kim](#)

Gwangju, South Korea

- Researched test-time adaptation with reinforcement learning for self-improving reasoning capabilities of large language models on the Abstract Reasoning Corpus (ARC)
- Investigated metacognition-driven strategies for helping large language models escape local minima in reasoning

Forschungszentrum Jülich

September 2024 - February 2025

Korea-Germany Junior Research Fellowship Program 2024

Jülich, Germany

- Host Institute: INM-7 directed by [Prof. Simon B. Eickhoff](#) and contributed to Mathematical Neuroscience Group led by [Dr. Oleksandr Popovych](#).
- Developed preprocessing pipeline for multi-modal MRI human connectome data using HPC and HyperThreading (Project Supervisor: [Dr. Kyesam Jung](#))

PUBLICATIONS

From Noise to Diversity: Random Embedding Injection in LLM Reasoning

Heejun Kim, Seungpil Lee, Jewon Yeom, Jaewon Sok, Seonghyeon Park, Jeongjae Park, Taesup Kim, Sundong Kim
NeurIPS 2026, ICML 2026 Mechanistic Interpretability Workshop (Spotlight, 2.8% acceptance rate). [\[Paper\]](#)

Hallucination as Commitment Failure: Larger LLMs Misfire Despite Knowing the Answer

Jewon Yeom, Jaewon Sok, [Heejun Kim](#), Seonghyeon Park, Jeongjae Park, Taesup Kim
NeurIPS 2026, ICML 2026 Mechanistic Interpretability Workshop. [\[Paper\]](#)

On the Role of Proposal Support in Diffusion-Based Offline RL for Sequential Decision-Making

Yunho Kim, Jaehyun Park, [Heejun Kim](#), Sejin Kim, Byung-Jun Lee, Sundong Kim
ICML 2026 DEMO Workshop. [\[Paper\]](#)

PROJECTS

Skill-based Reinforcement Learning with UCB Skill Selection

May 2025 - June 2025

- Reproduced BeCL framework for unsupervised skill discovery in reinforcement learning environments
- Developed Multi-Armed Bandit approach with UCB algorithm to improve downstream task adaptation efficiency. [\[Poster\]](#)

Hyundai AI Challenge

September 2023 - October 2023

- Processed large-scale port logistics datasets (cleaning, feature extraction, temporal aggregation).
- Built tree-based boosting models to predict ship waiting times.
- Ranked Top 25/330 teams among 1,300+ participants.

LEADERSHIPS

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2025

- Machine Learning & Deep Learning (AI5213/EC4213): led TA sessions, held office hours, managed assignments/exams, and organized Kaggle competition. [\[Homepage\]](#)

Korea Army Instructor

February 2021 - August 2022

- Served as an Army instructor in the 50th Division in Daegu, South Korea
- Conducted basic training for approximately 2000 military personnel

EXTRA ACTIVITIES

Google Developer Student Club

September 2023 - February 2024

- Participated in an AI study focused on machine learning and deep learning
- Studied models in ML/DL and analysis of top team models in Kaggle AI competitions
- Established study directions and organized study materials as a team leader

Financial Investment Conference

March 2023 - March 2024

- Conducted a study on economics
- Analyzed and presented economic markets on a weekly basis

GIST Club Federation

February 2020 - December 2020

- Managed clubs in Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology

SKILLS

Programming Languages	Python, C/C++
Python Packages & Framework	PyTorch, VeRL, Scikit-learn, Pandas, Numpy, Matplotlib, Ray
Operating System	Linux, Windows, MacOS
Others	Docker, Wandb, SLURM, HTCondor, SQLite

HONORS

Government Scholarship, Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology	2020 - August 2026
Government Scholarship, STEM scholarship	2020 - August 2026
Dean's List, College of Information and Computing, GIST	Spring 2025, Fall 2025
GIST International Internship Support Program	September 2024 - February 2025
Korea-Germany Junior Research Fellowship Program 2024	September 2024 - February 2025
· Organized by the Max Planck POSTECH/KOREA Research (MPK)	
· Fund: 12,000,000 KRW (8,197 EUR) by National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF), No. RS-2023-00254343.	